

Word family: **uneven / unevenly / unevenness**

Base word: uneven

Part of speech: mainly **adjective**

Since **even** is already mapped in your database, I'll keep this entry focused on **uneven** and its own modern extensions rather than reopening the full **even** family.

Related forms:

* **uneven** (adj.) — 不平的；不平均的；不均匀的；不穩定的

* **unevenly** (adv.) — 不平均地；不均匀地；不平衡地

* **unevenness** (n.) — 不平；不均；不一致

Useful expressions / extensions:

* **uneven effort**

* **uneven distribution**

* **uneven surface**

* **uneven ground**

* **uneven road**

* **uneven floor**

* **uneven skin tone**

* **uneven growth**

* **uneven development**

* **uneven performance**

* **uneven progress**

* **uneven quality**

* **uneven pace**

* **uneven contest**

* **uneven bars**

* **unevenly distributed**

* **unevenly matched**

Meaning in this passage

> Many workers associate it with wasted time, **uneven effort** and unnecessary conflict.

Here, **uneven** means:

not equally distributed among different people — 不平均的；不均衡的

Some team members work much harder than others.

****中文翻譯：****

很多員工會把團隊合作和浪費時間、****付出不均****以及不必要的衝突聯想在一起。

So here:

****uneven effort = 不同組員投入的時間、精力和工作量明顯不相等****

1. ****uneven (不平均的；不均衡的) — 不平均的；不均衡的****

This is the exact sense used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> Group work often involves ****uneven effort****.

團隊合作經常出現****付出不均****的情況。

Practice 2

> The workload was ****unevenly distributed****.

工作量的分配****不平均****。

Practice 3

> There was an ****uneven division of responsibilities****.

責任的分配****不均衡****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****uneven = 沒有平均分配，不同部分或不同人之間的份量明顯不同****

2. ****uneven effort — 付出不均****

Practice 1

> ****Uneven effort**** can quickly create resentment.

****付出不均****很快就會引起不滿。

Practice 2

> The project suffered because of **uneven effort among team members**.

由於組員之間**付出不平均**，項目受到影響。

MCQ-ready definition:

uneven effort = 不同人投入的努力程度明顯不相等

3. **uneven distribution** — 分布不均；分配不均

Practice 1

> There was an **uneven distribution of work**.

工作出現**分配不均**。

Practice 2

> Wealth is **unevenly distributed** across the region.

財富在該地區的**分布並不平均**。

MCQ-ready definition:

uneven distribution = 某物在不同地方或不同人之間的分配並不平均

4. **uneven workload** — 工作量不均

Practice 1

> An **uneven workload** can damage team morale.

工作量不均會打擊團隊士氣。

Practice 2

> Managers should avoid giving employees **uneven workloads**.

管理人員應避免令員工之間的**工作量差距太大**。

MCQ-ready definition:

uneven workload = 不同人需要完成的工作量明顯不相等

5. **uneven** (表面不平) — 凹凸不平的；不平坦的

A major physical sense.

Practice 1

> Be careful—the floor is **uneven**.

小心，地面**凹凸不平**。

Practice 2

> The table stood on an **uneven surface**.

桌子放在一個**不平坦的表面**上。

MCQ-ready definition:

uneven = 表面高低不一，不平坦或不平滑

6. **uneven ground** — 不平地面；崎嶇地面

Practice 1

> Walking on **uneven ground** can be tiring.

在**不平的地面**上行走可能很累。

Practice 2

> Wear suitable shoes on **uneven ground**.

在**崎嶇地面**上應穿合適的鞋。

MCQ-ready definition:

uneven ground = 高低起伏、不平坦的地面

7. **uneven road / path** — 凹凸不平的道路 / 小徑

Practice 1

> The car moved slowly along the **uneven road**.

汽車沿着**凹凸不平的道路**慢慢行駛。

Practice 2

> The path becomes **uneven** near the hill.

靠近山坡時，小路會變得**崎嶇不平**。

MCQ-ready definition:

uneven road/path = 表面高低不一、不平整的道路或小路

8. **uneven (不均勻的) — 不均勻的**

A major appearance/material sense.

Practice 1

> The paint looks **uneven**.

油漆看起來**不均勻**。

Practice 2

> The colour was **uneven** across the wall.

牆上的顏色**深淺不一**。

MCQ-ready definition:

uneven = 顏色、厚度、質地等在不同位置並不一致

9. **uneven skin tone — 膚色不均**

Practice 1

> The product is designed for **uneven skin tone**.

這個產品是針對**膚色不均**而設。

Practice 2

> Sun exposure can contribute to **uneven skin tone**.

日曬可能導致**膚色不均勻**。

MCQ-ready definition:

uneven skin tone = 皮膚不同位置的顏色深淺不一致

10. **uneven texture — 質地不均；表面不均勻**

Practice 1

> The material has an **uneven texture**.

這種材料的**質地不均勻**。

Practice 2

> The wall had a rough, **uneven texture**.

牆面粗糙而且**凹凸不平**。

MCQ-ready definition:

uneven texture = 表面的手感、厚度或結構在不同位置不一致

11. **uneven growth — 生長不均**

Practice 1

> The plants showed **uneven growth**.

植物出現**生長不均**。

Practice 2

> Poor lighting caused **uneven growth**.

光線不足造成**生長不平均**。

MCQ-ready definition:

uneven growth = 不同部分、個體或時期的生長速度並不一致

12. **uneven development — 發展不均**

A common social/economic/organizational use.

Practice 1

> The country has experienced **uneven economic development**.

這個國家經歷了**不均衡的經濟發展**。

Practice 2

> There is **uneven development** between urban and rural areas.

城市和鄉郊之間的**發展並不均衡**。

MCQ-ready definition:

uneven development = 不同地區、部門或方面的發展速度和程度不一致

13. **uneven progress — 進展不一；進度不穩定**

Practice 1

> The team made **uneven progress**.

團隊的**進展並不穩定**。

Practice 2

> Recovery has been **uneven**.

康復進度一直**時好時壞 / 不太穩定**。

MCQ-ready definition:

uneven progress = 進展速度或成果並非一直穩定，有快有慢

14. **uneven performance — 表現不穩定；表現參差**

Practice 1

> The team's performance was **uneven**.

團隊的表現**參差不齊**。

Practice 2

> His **uneven performance** made the manager uncertain.

他**不穩定的表現**令經理有所疑慮。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****uneven performance = 不同時間或不同部分的表現水平差異很大****

15. **uneven quality — 質素參差不齊**

Practice 1

> The report was criticized for its **uneven quality**.

報告因**質素參差不齊**而受到批評。

Practice 2

> The series is entertaining but **uneven**.

這套劇集很有娛樂性，但**質素時好時壞**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****uneven quality = 不同部分的品質水平不一致****

16. **uneven pace — 節奏不穩；速度不一**

Practice 1

> The project moved forward at an **uneven pace**.

項目的進展**忽快忽慢**。

Practice 2

> The film has an **uneven pace**.

這部電影的**節奏不太穩定**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****uneven pace = 速度或節奏時快時慢，缺乏一致性****

17. ****uneven results — 成果參差；結果不一****

Practice 1

> The new method produced ****uneven results****.

新方法產生了****參差不一的結果****。

Practice 2

> The policy has had ****uneven results**** across different departments.

這項政策在不同部門產生的成果****並不一致****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****uneven results = 不同地方、時間或個案所得成果差異明顯****

18. ****uneven contest / match — 實力懸殊的比賽****

A useful figurative extension.

Practice 1

> It was an ****uneven contest**** from the beginning.

那場比賽從一開始便是****實力懸殊****。

Practice 2

> The two teams were ****unevenly matched****.

兩支球隊的****實力並不匹配****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****uneven contest = 雙方能力或實力差距很大的競爭****

19. **unevenly matched — 實力不對等**

Practice 1

> The two sides were badly **unevenly matched**.

雙方的**實力相差很大**。

Practice 2

> The debate felt **unevenly matched** because one speaker had far more experience.

由於其中一位講者經驗豐富得多，這場辯論顯得**實力並不對等**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****unevenly matched = 兩方能力、資源或實力並不相稱****

20. **uneven bars — 高低槓**

A fixed gymnastics term.

Practice 1

> She competes on the **uneven bars**.

她參加**高低槓**比賽。

Practice 2

> The **uneven bars** are used in women's artistic gymnastics.

****高低槓**是女子競技體操項目之一。**

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****uneven bars = 由兩條高度不同的橫槓組成的體操器械及相關項目****

This is lexicalized and should be learned as a fixed sports term.

21. **unevenly — 不平均地；不均勻地**

Practice 1

> The work was **unevenly divided**.

工作被**不平均地分配**。

Practice 2

> The paint was applied **unevenly**.

油漆塗得**不均勻**。

MCQ-ready definition:

unevenly = 以不平均、不一致或不均勻的方式

22. **unevenly distributed** — 分布不均

Practice 1

> Opportunities are **unevenly distributed**.

機會的**分布並不平均**。

Practice 2

> The workload was **unevenly distributed across the team**.

工作量在團隊中**分配不均**。

MCQ-ready definition:

unevenly distributed = 某物在不同人或地方之間的份量不相等

23. **unevenness** — 不平；不均；參差

Practice 1

> The **unevenness of the floor** made walking difficult.

地面的**凹凸不平**令人難以行走。

Practice 2

> The report highlighted the **unevenness of regional development**.

報告指出地區發展的**不均衡**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****unevenness = 不平坦、不平均或缺乏一致性的狀態****

Important distinction 1: ****uneven vs unequal****

This is the most important distinction for your passage.

****unequal****

not the same in amount, size, status, etc.

****uneven****

not evenly distributed or not consistent across people, places, or time.

> unequal pay

> 薪酬不相等

> uneven effort

> 付出不均

For effort, both are possible, but ****uneven effort**** naturally emphasizes that some members work hard while others contribute little.

Important distinction 2: ****uneven vs unfair****

****uneven****

describes imbalance.

****unfair****

evaluates it as unjust.

> uneven workload

> 工作量不平均

> unfair workload

> 工作量分配不公平

An uneven distribution may lead to unfairness, but **uneven** itself is more descriptive.

Important distinction 3: **uneven vs inconsistent**

uneven

varies in level, quality, amount, or pace.

inconsistent

does not remain the same or follow a stable pattern.

> uneven performance

> 表現參差

> inconsistent behaviour

> 行為不一致

They overlap strongly in performance contexts.

Important distinction 4: **uneven vs irregular**

irregular

does not follow a normal or predictable pattern.

uneven

emphasizes differences in level, amount, surface, or quality.

> irregular schedule

> 不規律的時間表

> uneven workload

> 不均衡的工作量

Important distinction 5: **uneven vs rough**

For surfaces:

uneven

high and low in different places.

rough

not smooth to the touch.

A surface can be:

- * uneven but smooth,
- * flat but rough,
- * both uneven and rough.

Important distinction 6: **uneven vs unbalanced**

uneven

different amounts or levels.

unbalanced

one side/aspect has too much weight or importance compared with another.

- > uneven distribution of work
- > 工作分配不均

- > unbalanced diet
- > 飲食不均衡

They overlap, but collocations differ.

Important distinction 7: **uneven vs patchy**

patchy

good/present in some areas but poor/absent in others, often visibly in patches.

uneven

broader: simply not consistent.

> patchy internet coverage

> 網絡覆蓋時有時無

> uneven service quality

> 服務質素參差

Important distinction 8: **uneven effort vs unequal contribution**

uneven effort

different levels of **input**.

unequal contribution

different amounts/value of actual **output contributed**.

A person might put in lots of effort but still contribute less because they lack experience.

Your passage focuses first on the imbalance in **effort**, then later makes **contribution visible**.

Important distinction 9: **uneven performance vs poor performance**

poor performance

consistently bad.

uneven performance

sometimes good, sometimes weak.

So **uneven** means variability, not necessarily low quality overall.

Important distinction 10: **uneven progress vs slow progress**

slow progress

consistently moves forward slowly.

uneven progress

sometimes fast, sometimes slow, possibly with setbacks.

Different patterns.

Important distinction 11: ****uneven quality****

This often means:

****some parts are excellent, others are weak****

not:

****everything is mediocre****

This is common in reviews of:

- * books,
- * films,
- * reports,
- * performances.

Important distinction 12: ****uneven distribution****

This can refer to:

- * workload,
- * wealth,
- * rainfall,
- * population,
- * resources,
- * opportunities.

The core idea stays:

****some places/groups have much more than others****

Important distinction 13: ****uneven bars****

This is a fixed sports term and does not mean generally “bars that happen to be uneven.”

In gymnastics, **the uneven bars** specifically refers to the apparatus with two bars set at different heights.

Family-extension note

Uneven has a coherent semantic core:

not equal, level, smooth, or consistent across different parts

That branches into:

1. **distribution**

- * uneven effort
- * uneven workload
- * uneven distribution

2. **physical surfaces**

- * uneven ground
- * uneven road

3. **appearance/material**

- * uneven colour
- * uneven texture
- * uneven skin tone

4. **development**

- * uneven growth
- * uneven development

5. **performance/progress**

- * uneven performance
- * uneven quality
- * uneven pace

6. **relative strength**

- * uneven contest
- * unevenly matched

7. **sports lexicalization**

* uneven bars

8. **adverb/noun family**

* unevenly

* unevenness

For your passage, the exact branch is:

uneven effort = the amount of effort is not equally or fairly spread across team members

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
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uneven	不平的；不均衡的	not evenly distributed
uneven effort	付出不均	unequal input
uneven distribution	分布 / 分配不均	unequal spread
uneven workload	工作量不均	workload imbalance
uneven surface	不平坦表面	physical level
uneven ground	凹凸不平地面	terrain
uneven road	凹凸不平道路	physical surface
uneven colour	顏色不均	inconsistent appearance
uneven skin tone	膚色不均	appearance
uneven texture	質地不均	physical texture
uneven growth	生長不均	development
uneven development	發展不均	regional/structural
uneven progress	進度不穩	inconsistent progress
uneven performance	表現參差	variable performance
uneven quality	質素參差	variable quality
uneven pace	節奏 / 速度不一	variable pace
uneven results	結果參差	variable outcomes
uneven contest	實力懸殊的比賽	unequal ability
unevenly matched	實力不對等	mismatch
uneven bars	高低槓	gymnastics
unevenly	不平均地；不均勻地	manner
unevenness	不平；不均	state

For your original sentence

> Many workers associate it with wasted time, **uneven effort** and unnecessary conflict.

Here:

uneven effort = 團隊中的努力沒有平均分布，有些人做很多，有些人做很少

This directly prepares the next paragraph:

> some employees **shoulder most of the burden**

> while others **contribute very little**

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 很多員工會把團隊合作和浪費時間、**付出不均**以及不必要的衝突聯想在一起。

The cleanest contrast is:

> **unequal** = 數量不相等

> **uneven** = 分布、程度或表現不平均 / 不一致

> **unfair** = 不公平

> **inconsistent** = 不穩定、不一致

For this passage, **uneven** is precise because it describes the **imbalance in how much effort is spread across different members**, which then becomes a source of perceived unfairness.